Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 9 8 6 ♥ K Q J 10 ♦ K 10 8 6 ♣ 3	
♠ Q 10 4 3 ♥ 6 3 2 ♦ 7 5 ♣ A 10 8 7		♠ J 7 2 ♥ 7 4 ♦ J 9 4 3 2 ♣ 9 6 2
	♠ K 5 ♥ A 9 8 5 ♦ A Q ♣ K Q J 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	1♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣2

You **MIGHT** say that with 13 points and partner controlling the ♣s you could jump to 2NT, "To show you my points, partner."You might say it but you won't because your first priority is to look for a Major suit fit. You bid 1♥ (skipping ♦s with the two Majors). Partner now jumps to 4♥.

Partner says you can make game even if you have a minimum 6 points. So he must have about 20. So you think you can make slam and you bid 4NT. Partner answers 5♥.

Partner shows 2 Aces so you bid 6♥.

Board 2
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A K ♥ K 10 ♦ K Q J 9 4 ♣ K 10 8 3	
♠ 9 8 5 3 ♥ 9 8 6 4 ♦ 6 2 ♣ 9 7 4	N W E S	♠ J 7 4 2 ♥ J 7 3 2 ♦ A 5 3 ♣ J 6
	♠ Q 10 6 ♥ A Q 5 ♦ 10 8 7 ♣ A Q 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♥8

You dealt this hand.

You have 20 points and it would not be terrible to open 2NT. However, strictly speaking you shouldn't open 2NT with two doubletons. So you open 1♦. Partner responds with a jump to 2NT.

With partner's 13-15 added onto your 20, bidding 6NT would be a reasonable bid. However, it costs nothing to check for Aces first, so you bid 4♣. (Everybody agrees this is Gerber, right?)Partner answers 4♠.

Easy, missing one Ace you bid 6NT.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 9 2
♥ A K Q 10 5
♦ A K
♣ K Q J

♠ K 6 4
♥ 9 3
♦ J 7 5 3
♣ 10 8 7 2

♠ 5
♥ J 8 7 4 2
♦ Q 9 4 2
♣ 9 5 4

♠ A Q J 8 7 3
♥ 6
♦ 10 8 6
♣ A 6 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	6♣[4]
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 0 kings

6NT by North
Lead: ♦2

You dealt this hand.

With 13 points and a good Major suit you naturally open 1♠. Partner responds 3♥.

We are playing strong jump-shifts by Responder so partner is showing 17+ points. However, you are still stuck with your minimum opening so you just rebid 3♠. Partner bids 4NT. What is your reply?

He asks for Aces so you bid 5♥ showing 2. He now bids 5NT.

You have no King. So you reply 6♣ and partner bids 6NT (safer than 6♠).

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ A K
♥ K 8 5 3
♦ K Q J 4
♣ A 9 3

♠ Q 9
♥ J 10
♦ 10 9 7 6 5
♣ Q J 10 7

♠ J 10 8 7 5 3
♥ 6
♦ A 8 3 2
♣ K 6

♠ 6 4 2
♥ A Q 9 7 4 2
♦ —
♣ 8 5 4 2

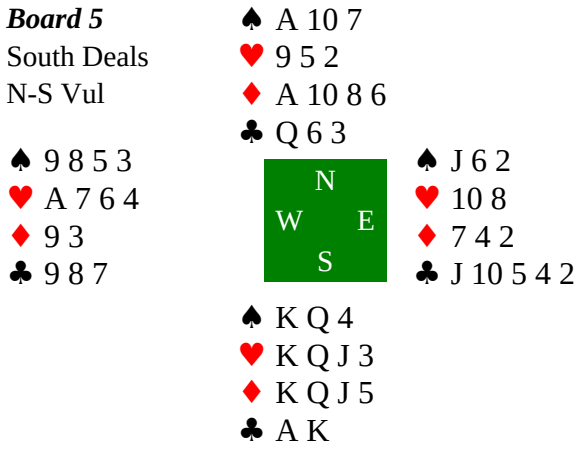
West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣Q

You need to find out about Aces so you bid 4NT. Partner says 6♦.

Partner has shown one Ace and a ♦ void. As to what you bid, that's easy. You have no choice now but to say 6♥. This is a pretty good slam, but it is not cold. Maybe West will not lead a ♣. Or maybe East will have the ♦A.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♠6

Not everybody responds to 2♣ openers the same way. But with 9 balanced points 2NT is reasonable. Partner jumps to 4♣.

With 2 Aces your response is 4♠. Partner bids 6NT and you pass.